VENICE, ITALY

Gallerie dell’Accademia: Masterpieces

Twenty works in which architecture, crowds and intervals shape a story.



In Carpaccio's Rialto painting, the miracle is easier to miss than the city. Boats, bridge and buildings claim attention around the episode that gives the work its name. That distribution offers a useful way into this selection: the apparent background often determines how slowly a story becomes visible and how widely its effects are imagined to spread.

Venetian streets and interiors organise several of these works, while ceiling compositions replace built enclosures with an opening into the sky. Giorgione's *Tempest* offers a different difficulty, leaving the relationship between its figures unresolved. The guide moves among these ways of locating an event, without assuming that every painting supplies one certain narrative answer.

Artline selected these works from documented museum holdings. The selection is independent of the museum, and individual works may be on loan or off display. Dates and attributions retain the qualifications in the linked records.

Explore this selection in Artline

See the selected works alongside books and events from their period, or compare when the artists lived. The books and events provide context, not evidence of direct influence. Works without confirmed dates remain in this guide.

Artworks in context Who lived when?

artlines.org/guides/accademia-venice

The selection · 20

1. Miracle of the True Cross at the Rialto Bridge
   Vittore Carpaccio · 1494
2. Feast in the House of Levi
   Paolo Veronese · 1573
3. Arrival of the English Ambassadors
   Vittore Carpaccio · 1498
4. The Transport of the Holy House of Nazareth to Loreto
   Giovanni Battista Tiepolo · 1743
5. The Coronation of the Virgin
   Michele Giambono · c. 1448
6. The Crucifixion
   Andrea Previtali · 1515–1520
7. The Finding of Jesus in the Temple
   Giovanni Antonio Fumiani · c. 1700
8. Saint Dominic in Glory
   Giovanni Battista Tiepolo · 1723
9. The Tempest
   Giorgione · 1503–1509; usually dated c. 1504
10. Vitruvian Man
    Leonardo da Vinci · 1492
11. Miracle of the Relic of the Holy Cross
    Benedetto Diana · 1505–1510
12. Miracle of the Cross at Campo San Lio
    Giovanni di Niccolò Mansueti · c. 1494
13. The Raising of Lazarus
    Leandro Bassano · c. 1610
14. The Assumption of the Virgin
    Palma Vecchio · c. 1513
15. The Healing of the Daughter of Benvegnudo of San Polo
    Giovanni di Niccolò Mansueti · c. 1505
16. The Relic of the Holy Cross Offered to the Scuola di San Giovanni Evangelista
    Lazzaro Bastiani · c. 1494
17. The Soothsayer
    Pietro Longhi · 1752
18. The Dream of Saint Ursula
    Vittore Carpaccio · 1495
19. Self-Portrait
    Rosalba Carriera · 1746
20. The Miracle of Saint Mark Freeing the Slave
    Tintoretto · 1548

01 / 20

Miracle of the True Cross at the Rialto Bridge

Vittore Carpaccio

1494 · Oil and tempera on canvas · Gallerie dell'Accademia



Vittore Carpaccio. The Miracle of the Relic of the True Cross on the Rialto Bridge. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/vittore-carpaccio/the-miracle-of-the-relic-of-the-true-cross-on-the-rialto-bridge-1494 · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

Gondolas and the old wooden bridge make the canal immediately conspicuous. The miraculous episode occupies a much smaller place at the upper left. Carpaccio allows the city to sustain activities beyond the named story. The work can be read as a sacred event situated within public life, rather than a city emptied out to provide its backdrop.

Object source · Open artwork

02 / 20

Feast in the House of Levi

Paolo Veronese

1573 · Oil on canvas · Gallerie dell’Accademia



Feast in the House of Levi (Last Supper). WikiArt; Paolo Veronese. Proportional resizing and JPEG compression; source frame preserved. · Public domain

Three great arches give the banquet an expansive structure, but they do not keep attention fixed at the central table. Servants, animals and peripheral figures repeatedly draw the eye elsewhere. Veronese makes the surrounding social world part of the meal's presentation. Architecture holds the gathering together while allowing several incidents to compete within it.

Object source · Open artwork

03 / 20

Arrival of the English Ambassadors

Vittore Carpaccio

1498 · Oil on canvas · Gallerie dell’Accademia



Vittore Carpaccio. The Arrival of the English Ambassadors. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/vittore-carpaccio/the-arrival-of-the-english-ambassadors-1498 · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

Halls, steps and openings separate groups while keeping passages between them visible. Carpaccio uses architecture to organise moments in a narrative, asking the eye to move rather than settle at one central encounter. The buildings have a temporal role as well as a spatial one. Crossing the painted room can mean advancing through the story.

Object source · Open artwork

04 / 20

The Transport of the Holy House of Nazareth to Loreto

Giovanni Battista Tiepolo

1743 · Oil on canvas · Gallerie dell'Accademia



Transportation of the Holy House of Nazareth to Loreto. WikiArt; Giovanni Battista Tiepolo. Proportional resizing and JPEG compression; source frame preserved. · Public domain

Masonry enters an arrangement of clouds, angels and airborne drapery. Tiepolo makes the miraculous transport intelligible through a contradiction between the building's implied weight and its diagonal movement across the oval field. The surrounding figures help carry that improbable relation. The house remains substantial enough for its suspension to matter.

Object source · Open artwork

05 / 20

The Coronation of the Virgin

Michele Giambono

c. 1448 · Gallerie dell'Accademia



Michele Giambono. Coronation of the Virgin. Image credit: Michele Giambono. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Repeated heads, haloes and levels organise the dense assembly around the elevated Christ and Mary. Giambono gives heaven a ceremonial order without needing a naturalistic room. Gold and red bind the ranks together while individual figures remain identifiable. The picture's crowded surface communicates hierarchy through placement rather than through ordinary distances between bodies.

Object source · Open artwork

06 / 20

The Crucifixion

Andrea Previtali

1515–1520 · Gallerie dell'Accademia



Andrea Previtali. Crucifixion. Image credit: Didier Descouens. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The cross connects the immediate group of mourners to an extensive landscape. Previtali leaves room around the event, allowing changes of light to distinguish the hill from the farther terrain. The vertical holds the scene together without requiring the people to fill it. The place continues beyond the subject at its centre.

Object source · Open artwork

07 / 20

The Finding of Jesus in the Temple

Giovanni Antonio Fumiani

c. 1700 · Gallerie dell'Accademia



Giovanni Antonio Fumiani. Finding of Jesus in the Temple. Image credit: Didier Descouens. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The child occupies only part of an imposing gathering among columns and steps. Fumiani makes the surrounding institution physically large while directing its figures into argument and attention. Gestures prevent the architecture from becoming a merely formal display. The difference between Jesus's bodily scale and the response around him makes the subject legible.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: Cat.1390

08 / 20

Saint Dominic in Glory

Giovanni Battista Tiepolo

1723 · Gallerie dell’Accademia



Giovanni Battista Tiepolo. Giambattista Tiepolo, San Domenico in gloria. Image credit: Didier Descouens. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Shortened views of limbs suggest bodies seen from below, while pale openings break through darker figures near the edges. Tiepolo's ceiling arrangement asks the painted space to continue above the viewer rather than recede like a window on a wall. A flat reproduction preserves the design but cannot fully reproduce that intended bodily position beneath it.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: Cat.810

09 / 20

The Tempest

Giorgione

1503–1509; usually dated c. 1504 · Canvas; paint medium not specified · Gallerie dell’Accademia



Giorgione. La tempesta. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

Lightning links the unsettled sky to a landscape divided between the standing man and nursing woman. Their relationship is not explained by a decisive shared action. Giorgione gives the intervening ground, ruins and distant buildings substantial attention. The painting remains available for precise description even when no single narrative interpretation can be stated as certain.

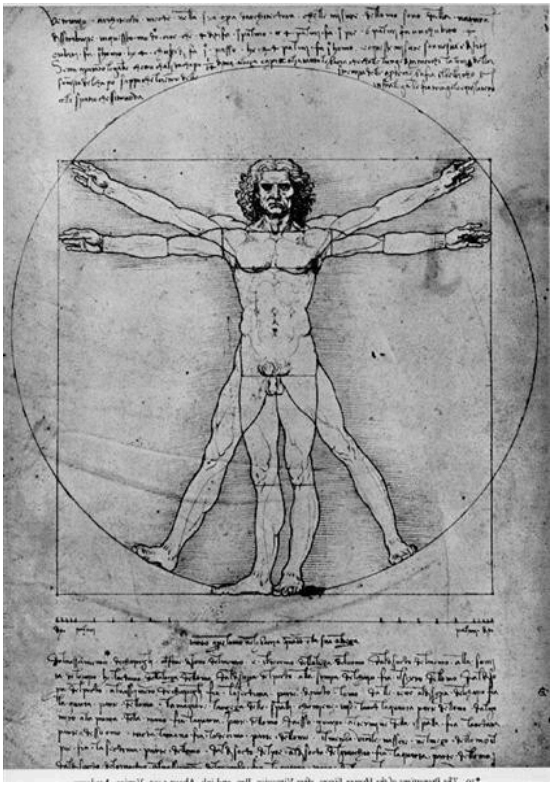
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 915

10 / 20

Vitruvian Man

Leonardo da Vinci

1492 · Gallerie dell'Accademia



Leonardo da Vinci. The proportions of the human figure (The Vitruvian Man). Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The superimposed arms and legs do not represent one stationary pose. Leonardo compares bodily proportions with a circle and square through different positions, accompanied by written notes. The familiar emblem is therefore also a working diagram. The original drawing is not a permanent-display attraction: conservation limits access, so any opportunity to see it must be confirmed separately.

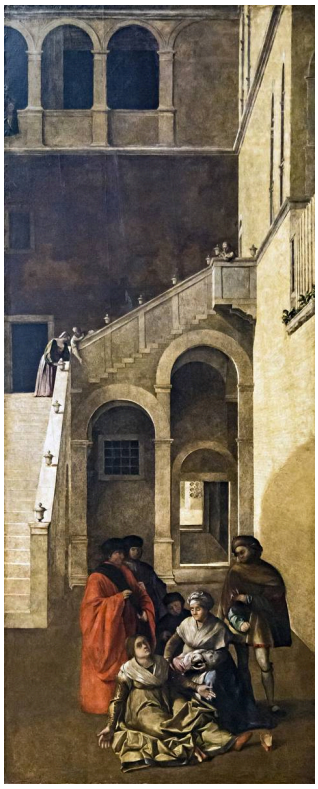
Object source · Open artwork

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Miracle of the Relic of the Holy Cross

Benedetto Diana

1505–1510 · Gallerie dell'Accademia



Benedetto Rusconi. Miracle of the Relic of the Holy Cross. Image credit: Didier Descouens. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The small group, including a child, occupies the lower part of an unusually tall architectural setting. Benedetto Diana makes discovery of the action slower by allowing arch and wall to command so much space. The human episode gains a spacious frame rather than a close-up. Scale changes how the event is approached before its details are understood.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: Cat.565

12 / 20

Miracle of the Cross at Campo San Lio

Giovanni di Niccolò Mansueti

c. 1494 · Gallerie dell'Accademia



Giovanni di Niccolò Mansueti. Miracle of the Relic of the Holy Cross in Campo San Lio. Image credit: Didier Descouens. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

White garments create a conspicuous band through the crowded square. Around the procession, spectators and detailed façades locate devotion within an urban community. Mansueti makes the ceremony's public character visible through repetition and watching. The event includes those taking part and those whose presence turns it into something collectively witnessed.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: Cat.564

13 / 20

The Raising of Lazarus

Leandro Bassano

c. 1610 · Gallerie dell'Accademia



Leandro Bassano. Resurrection of Lazarus. Image credit: Didier Descouens. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Hands reach and bodies bend around the pale figure close to the ground. Leandro Bassano lets light distinguish this crowded activity from the darker architecture above it. The miracle emerges through physical relations rather than an isolated emblem of divine power. The lower space remains a place of support and effort as the event unfolds.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: Cat.252

14 / 20

The Assumption of the Virgin

Palma Vecchio

c. 1513 · Gallerie dell'Accademia



Palma Vecchio. The Assumption of the Virgin. Image credit: Palma Vecchio; https://www.gallerieaccademia.it/assunzione-della-vergine. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:315_Palma_il_Vecchio_Assunzione_della_Vergine_(trsp).png. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The apostles look and gesture upwards across the gap separating them from Mary. Palma Vecchio makes that interval active: it records distance while carrying a continuous exchange of attention. Earthly witnesses and the ascending figure occupy different levels, yet neither group becomes a self-contained scene. Their relation supplies the composition's direction.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 315

15 / 20

The Healing of the Daughter of Benvegnudo of San Polo

Giovanni di Niccolò Mansueti

c. 1505 · Gallerie dell'Accademia



Giovanni di Niccolò Mansueti. The Miraculous Healing of the Daughter of Benvegnudo of San Polo. Image credit: Didier Descouens. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

A broad staircase divides the interior and gives witnesses several positions from which to attend to the gathering below. Mansueti makes a household's architecture distribute the event beyond its immediate participants. The healing acquires reach through passages and levels. The building organises who can see and how separate groups belong to one scene.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: Cat.562

16 / 20

The Relic of the Holy Cross Offered to the Scuola di San Giovanni Evangelista

Lazzaro Bastiani

c. 1494 · Gallerie dell'Accademia



Lazzaro Bastiani. The Relic of the Holy Cross is offered to the Scuola Grande di San Giovanni Evangelista. Image credit: Didier Descouens. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Contrasting robes distinguish participants in a ceremonial exchange before the church and adjoining buildings. Bastiani gives the institution's defining ritual a public location rather than an abstract ceremonial field. Architecture helps stabilise an account of collective memory. The exchange is presented as something belonging to the city as well as to the people immediately involved.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: Cat.561

17 / 20

The Soothsayer

Pietro Longhi

1752 · Gallerie dell'Accademia



Pietro Longhi. The Soothsayer. Image credit: Didier Descouens. Wikimedia Commons. CC BY-SA 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · CC BY-SA 4.0

Some faces are masked while others remain visible around the fortune-teller. Longhi gives the social gathering as much attention as the promise of prediction. The masks introduce a useful complication: people seeking knowledge participate while withholding parts of their own appearance. Bright clothes and dark headwear keep the small groups distinct inside that exchange.

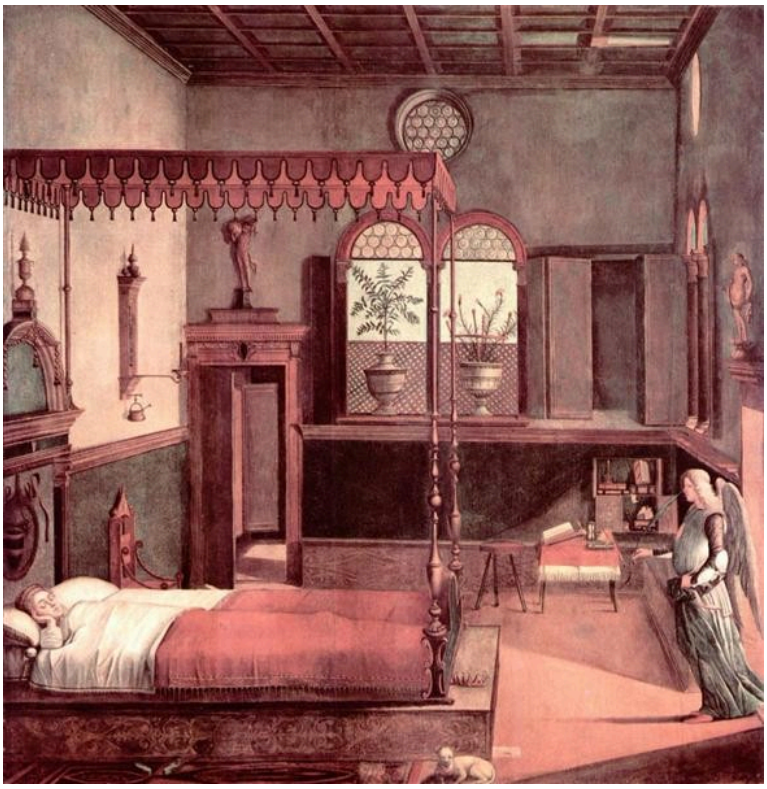
Object source · Open artwork

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The Dream of Saint Ursula

Vittore Carpaccio

1495 · Gallerie dell'Accademia



Vittore Carpaccio. Dream of St.Ursula. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

Tiles, windows and furnishings establish the room before the entering angel alters its ordinary use. Carpaccio places a visionary subject within a carefully measured interior, with Ursula asleep rather than actively receiving a visitor. The setting's plausibility sharpens the difference introduced at the doorway. A dream is given the physical organisation of household space.

Object source · Open artwork

19 / 20

Self-Portrait

Rosalba Carriera

1746 · Gallerie dell’Accademia



Rosalba Carriera. Self-Portrait. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

Carriera's pale face emerges through small tonal differences beneath grey hair. Soft edges join skin and clothing without making the likeness indistinct. The pastel offers a direct encounter that does not depend on a hard continuous contour. Attention belongs to the particular transitions around the features rather than an idealised, uniformly smooth account of the face.

Object source · Open artwork

20 / 20

The Miracle of Saint Mark Freeing the Slave

Tintoretto

1548 · Gallerie dell’Accademia



Tintoretto. The Miracle of St Mark Freeing the Slave. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The plunging saint and horizontal body establish opposing axes across the central space. Tintoretto makes the gap between heaven and earth a path of action, with onlookers responding through markedly different gestures. The extreme bodily angles distinguish intervention from spectatorship. The miracle's force is carried through the arrangement before the surrounding crowd is read person by person.

Object source · Open artwork

Let the setting take time

In the narrative paintings, follow a staircase, a canal or an opening before searching for the named protagonist. Architecture often explains how the event is shared. Check current displays and special exhibitions before visiting, particularly for works on paper such as Leonardo's drawing.

Further reading

A Treatise on Painting

Leonardo da Vinci; translated by John Francis Rigaud · Read free · English

Leonardo’s writings on proportion, perspective and movement accompany the questions raised by the Vitruvian Man. The book also provides terms for comparing the measured city views with Tintoretto’s foreshortened bodies.

Museum website · Official collection guide

Sources and visitor information checked: 2026-10-12

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